

Aug 10, 2026

Dr. Solorzano, Principal
Belmont HS (LAUSD)
1575 W 2nd St, Los Angeles, CA 90026
mss0819@lausd.net
(213) 241-4300

Dear Principal Solorzano,

I am applying for the pre-Calculus and AP Calculus teaching positions at Belmont HS for the 2026-2027 school year. Teaching has been a throughline of my life going as far back as high school, and I am eager to culminate its integration into my professional career.

As a black belt karate instructor in high school, teaching students spanning ages from 6 to 60 gave me a keen appreciation for the distinction between the roles of knowledge transfer and mental/emotional development in education. This sensitivity served me in college when I tutored friends and taught formally as a TA, and during my years as a software engineer while presented new technologies and workflows. These strands of education coalesced while living in Korea, where I worked at an edtech Hagwon and founded a Toastmasters club, developing a novel education program for ESL speakers to overcome their hesitancy to speak. Finally, over the past 5 years I brought these disparate experiences together into a coherent program when I founded a karate dojo where I have been developing from the ground up an off-the-mat curriculum relating karate to such diverse disciplines as visual arts, cognition, chess, and physics.

I am excited for the opportunity to further discuss how I can adapt my experience and skills to meet the demands of the math classroom in order to best serve the needs of the students and the broader community.

Sincerely,

David Chung
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